



ONLINE Spanish Program SPAN 101

INSTRUCTOR CONTACT INFORMATION

Instructor's Note: Hello, my name is **Eduardo A Medina**, and you can reach me by email at **edmedina@arizona.edu**. First, I would like to introduce you to the course (You can find more information about me in the "Start Here" module).

Office Hours: Office hours are held **Tue & Thu 12-1:00PM** or by appointment. Please refer to our course page to schedule a virtual meeting using the calendar provided. If you prefer an in-person meeting, please contact me via email.

BASIC COURSE INFORMATION

Course Description: Welcome to our fully online Spanish language series, spanning four courses from SPAN 101 to SPAN 202! In these courses, you'll embark on an immersive journey into the Spanish language and culture. Although our class is primarily asynchronous, you will participate in synchronous meetings with virtual exchange partners, providing real-world practice and cultural exchange. In addition, you will meet at least two times with me: once in the instructor-student meeting, and once for the final oral exam. Assignments for this course are due every Sunday and Wednesday, and you are expected to spend 6-8 hours per week on course activities.

Prerequisites: Span 101 is for students who have never taken a Spanish course and do not speak Spanish at home. Span 102 is for students who have completed Span 101, taken another introductory course, or have tested into 102 via an AP Exam or placement test but do not speak Spanish at home (please right-click [Advising](#) to open a new window for placement and proficiency exam questions). These courses are not for students who speak Spanish at home or have learned Spanish abroad. If you speak Spanish at home please refer to the [heritage program](#).

REQUIRED TEXTBOOK AND TOOLS

Portales 2e (SPAN 101 & 102)

 Textbook cover image

Publisher: Vista Higher Learning.

Note: You will use the first half of this textbook for Span 101 and the second half of this book for Spanish 102. The majority of the coursework will be completed via the Vista

Higher Learning (VHL) website.

Publisher: Vista Higher Learning.

Note: You will use the first half of this textbook for Span 201 and the second half of this book for Spanish 202. The majority of the coursework will be completed via the Vista Higher Learning (VHL) website.

Conversifi: You will use this online platform for virtual language exchange sessions.

Purchasing Materials: You can buy both VHL and Conversifi through P1P/Inclusive Access or purchase directly from each vendor depending on your individual needs. You can find the links to activate your access directly in D2L in the Conversifi Instructions and the VHL Access and Activities modules.

TECHONLOGY REQUIREMENTS

In order to succeed in this course, at a minimum, you should be able to access information and communicate online, engage in safe and responsible online conduct, and create and share digital content. You can view additional resources in the Start Here Menu under Tech Requirements and Help and Special Course Technology.

*If you're unfamiliar with any of the following tasks or need help meeting the technological requirements, please contact UA tech support or seek online resources for assistance.

<http://uits.arizona.edu/departments/the247>

- Have reliable access to a PC or Mac computer/laptop.
- Have reliable access to the internet, a web camera, and a microphone.
- Be able to upload and download documents in digital formats.
- Know how to manage plug-ins, flash players, pop-up blockers, and download applications to your PC/Mac.
- Make presentations with voiceovers.
- Record via Zoom and other applications.
- Use Microsoft Word to type compositions and other written assignments required in the course. Google links, PDFs, etc. will not be accepted. The U of A offers free software to students. Please click [here](#) for more information.
- Have Google Chrome installed as it is the best browser to access your VHL and Conversifi activities.

COURSE OBJECTIVES AND STUDENT OUTCOMES

The course objectives align with ACTFL standards (<https://www.actfl.org/terms-and-conditions>) and incorporate NACE career readiness competencies (<https://www.nacweb.org/career-readiness/competencies/career-readiness-defined>) to enhance students' communication, critical thinking, and cultural fluency. These objectives not only improve Spanish language proficiency but also prepare students for professional environments where these competencies are crucial.

SPAN 101: COURSE LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Incorporate grammar and vocabulary presented in class in guided conversations.
- Write meaningful messages using grammar and vocabulary in creative ways.
- Create and deliver simple oral presentations in Spanish.
- Listen and respond to guided, uncomplicated impromptu conversations with a variety of Spanish speakers.
- Read short passages in Spanish and summarize the information conveyed.
- Develop Professional skills relevant to the use of Spanish in the workplace.
- Cultivate culturally engaged reflexivity in students' communication.

STUDENT LEARNING OUTCOMES

Interpersonal Communication

1. Participate in oral conversations in Spanish - express ideas about highly familiar and everyday topics, likes/dislikes, introduce/describe yourself and others.
2. Participate in written exchanges (e.g. email, text, etc.) in Spanish with another person.

Interpretive Communication

3. Listen and respond to oral Spanish used by a variety of speakers (e.g. instructor, classmates, recordings, etc.).
4. Identify key points and summarize informational texts and oral conversations.

Presentational Communication

5. Deliver prepared material via oral communication (e.g. skits, partner presentations, power points, etc.).
6. Deliver prepared material via written communication (e.g. essays, paragraphs, summaries, etc.). Write a well-developed paragraph in Spanish using grammar and vocabulary reviewed during the semester.

Cultural Communication

7. Identify cultural practices and perspectives of the target culture(s).
8. Recognize cultural differences between your own culture and other cultures discussed in class.

Learning objectives that are specific to each course level can be found at the end of this syllabus under Language Acquisition Guidelines. The specific activities that meet these learning objectives will be provided in each learning module.

GRADES & ASSIGNMENTS

Written Assignments		Oral Assignments	
E-textbook Activities (weekly)	20%	Virtual Language Exchanges (2)	20%
Compositions (1)	10%	Reflection (1)	10%

Participation	10%	Oral Presentations (1)	10%
Cultural activity (1) (can be either written oral)	5%	Final Exam	15%

Grading Scale

90 - 100 = A	80 - 89 = B	70 - 79 = C	61 - 69 = D	60 or below = E
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FEEDBACK AND GRADING

The online program uses a holistic grading approach that is based on broad categories such as grammar, punctuation, vocabulary, and content. For oral and written assignments, I will provide a grade for each of these categories via an online rubric found in D2L. I will not mark every error in your assignment but will provide at least 2 specific examples of frequent errors that I have noticed in your assignment. You should use the examples/feedback that I provide as you review work again to identify these issues. Please feel free to contact me at any point in the course if you do not understand the feedback or need extra help with a specific problem.

ASSIGNMENTS

Submitting Assignments

The instructions and assignment links for your course are found in your D2L course shell. All assignments, unless otherwise announced, **MUST** be submitted to the designated area of D2L. Do not submit an assignment via email. Assignment due dates follow Arizona Standard time, click the following link to access [a time converter link](#) to ensure you account for the difference in Time Zones. Note: Arizona does not observe daylight savings time. The course schedule and due dates are located in the *Important Due Dates* portion of D2L.

PLEASE NOTE: The following guidelines will be strictly enforced with regard to the submission of all coursework: All work submitted for a grade in this course must be 100 percent your own work and must reflect the language structures and vocabulary that are taught in the course. Written work that reflects language skills that are more advanced than what is expected at your course level will be corroborated with your oral proficiency skills. The use of your textbook as a reference is permissible when completing homework and any in-class assignments, such as compositions. Unauthorized use of translators, such as Google Translate or any AI tools, is prohibited and the unauthorized use of such tools is considered plagiarism in our Spanish class. It is your responsibility to abide by the [University of Arizona Code of Academic Integrity](#). Any work submitted for a grade in

which unauthorized help was used will receive a grade of zero (0) regardless of the source of help in question. Violations will be reported to the Dean of Students.

Grading Procedure

Grades reflect your performance on assignments and adherence to deadlines. Assignment grades will be posted within one week of the due date. Please email me if you are concerned about the grade in any of your assignments. Missed assignments will receive a grade of 0 unless prior arrangements have been made and approved in writing (refer to the policy on late or missed assignments).

Late or Missed Assignments

Part of professional development is adhering to deadlines. All due dates can be located in the **Important Due Dates** portion of D2L. While late assignments are not accepted, we understand that life happens. To support your success and maintain fairness for all students, a one-time courtesy extension for late work is available. Please reach out to me, I am here to help you. Note that published assignment due dates (AZ Standard Time) are firm.

DESCRIPTION OF WRITTEN ACTIVITIES

E-Textbook activities (20%)

The online textbook exercises are to be completed each week by Wednesday and Sunday at 11:59 pm. Most assignments will be automatically graded by the system and you will have two attempts to complete most activities and achieve the highest score possible. Please refer to the VHL assignment calendar to know which assignments are due each week.

Compositions (10%)

You will complete one writing sample in Spanish throughout the semester. The length of the composition corresponds to your level of Spanish.

Rough Draft: You will complete your rough draft through the D2L Quizzes section. The use of websites -with the exception of D2L and VHL- and notes is not permitted. Compositions are individual assignments. **The assistance of tutors of any kind, Google Translate, or AI tools, while completing the quiz, is strictly forbidden and will result in a 0** (please see the Academic Integrity section in the University Policies and Student Resources section for more information). The rough draft will be 50% of your composition grade.

Final Draft: The final draft will be uploaded to Assignments. If you do not complete the rough draft of the composition, you must contact me as soon as possible to get the topic for the final draft. Note that you will receive a 0 for the rough draft if it is not completed.

When writing a composition, **you may only use the grammar structures that you have reviewed up to that point in the course.** If you violate this rule, and use grammar above your level, a grade of zero will be assigned to the grammar portion of the essay.

Participation (10%)

Participating in the course is vital to the learning process. If you anticipate not being able to participate in class online activities, please contact me as soon as possible. In order to show your participation during the semester, you are expected to complete the following activities:

- **Syllabus quiz:** After reading the syllabus thoroughly you will take a quiz to enhance your comprehension of the course.
- **Introduction video:** You will make a 2-3 minute video in English presenting yourself to the class and the instructor using *Feedback Fruits*.
- **Participation Evaluation:** You will evaluate your participation in the course using a template that will be provided.

DESCRIPTION OF CULTURAL ACTIVITY

Cultural Activity (5%)

You will complete 1 activity during the semester to prove your understanding of certain aspects of Hispanic culture, and your own cultural proficiency. The goal of these activities is to help you understand the link that exists between language and culture.

DESCRIPTION OF ORAL ACTIVITIES

Virtual language exchanges via Conversifi (20%)

Virtual exchanges will take place using the Conversifi platform. You will complete 2 Virtual Exchange assignments (*2 learner sessions per exchange). You will be graded on completion or non-completion of the 2 required Conversifi sessions from the assigned topics per Virtual Exchange.

You are encouraged to practice the vocabulary and use the prep sheets provided. Please remember that the Conversifi sessions are for you to practice natural speech with a native speaker so mistakes are expected as progress is made towards the end of the semester. See Important Due Dates module on D2L for specific dates.

Conversifi sessions are automatically recorded through the platform and you must follow the steps in the module to make these recordings visible to me.

Note: The Online Program does not require students to connect to each other via social networks such as Facebook or Instagram. All communication with virtual partners can be carried out through the assigned platform. It is the student's prerogative to provide information like their personal phone number or their social network accounts to their partners. It is not an expectation outlined by the program.

Reflection (10%)

You will create 1 Reflection about your virtual language exchange interactions with native speakers of Spanish. Oral Reflections will be created using Feedback Fruits. Students must ensure they follow the instructions in the corresponding module in order to receive full credit.

Oral Presentation (10%)

You will complete one oral presentations throughout the semester. Each presentation must be in Spanish and include 5 PowerPoint slides. Your presentation will be graded on pronunciation, grammar, fluency, content, and quality.

Peer Review - After posting your oral presentations in Feedback Fruits, provide feedback on two of your classmates' presentations, with comments for each one.

Please note: All comments posted Feedback Fruits, should be recorded in oral form (including those for the introduction videos) using webcam and microphone so that your classmates and I can see your face while you present.

Oral Exam (15%)

Please read the detailed instructions in the Oral Exam module. The oral exam will be divided into two sections: 1) Conversación Oral, and 2) the assessment of one Conversifi learner session selected by you.

The Conversación Oral portion of the exam will be held via the video conferencing tool Zoom on the day/time that you schedule your appointment. **A Webcam and mirror are required.** You should be able to show me your screen at the time of your meeting.

Video Recordings & Synchronous Meetings

- All online students are required to use a web camera for oral assignments. The use of the web camera helps to create a classroom community and ensures that the work is being done by the student enrolled in the course.
- Students must wear campus-appropriate clothing when recording class activities. Campus-appropriate clothing includes the use of a shirt and pants.
- Students' undergarments should not be visible in the recording. This applies to you and your surroundings. The only visible person in your recordings should be yourself.
- The video camera must clearly capture the student's face during the conversation.
- The recording must take place in an appropriate space and background.
- Recording should not be done from a bathroom or bed.
- If the background noise (animals, traffic, roommates, music, etc.) interferes with the video/sound quality, the recording may have to be redone. This will be determined by the professor.

Balancing Work and Homelife Responsibilities

- Students should do their best to schedule their video recordings around their children's schedules to prevent as many interruptions as possible.
- The presence of a baby or small child in the recording is permissible as long as they do not interfere with the students' ability to complete the learning activity. As a courtesy to your partner and to avoid interfering with their part of the recording, kindly mute yourself when it's not your turn to speak.
- We ask that mothers do not breastfeed during video recordings.

NETIQUETTE & ONLINE COURSE CONDUCT

- It is your responsibility to keep track of all information I provide in whichever format I deem appropriate. For each module, you will find an overview in addition to weekly reminders in Announcements in either written or video form. It is mandatory for you to watch these videos, and review all information provided in them. Not watching a video doesn't excuse you from the assignments.
- Allow me 24 hours to answer your emails (Monday-Friday).
- I am not required to answer your emails Saturdays & Sundays. Make sure that you look over your assignments before the weekend so that you can ask any questions you may have.
- Use common courtesy and Netiquette for online interactions with me. Always address me in the following manner:

Estimado Profesor: Eduardo A Medina

Your message in English

Atentamente,

Your Name

SPAN 101

Please consider the following:

- **Identify yourself.** Begin messages with a salutation and end them with your name.
- **Include a subject line.** Give a descriptive phrase in the subject line of the message header that tells the topic of the message and the course in which you are enrolled.
- **Avoid sarcasm.** People who don't know you may misinterpret its meaning.
- **Acknowledge and return messages promptly** (within 24 hrs).
- **Be concise.** Keep messages concise (about one screen, as a rule of thumb).
- **All correspondence is subject to the University Code of Academic Integrity.**
- **Use appropriate language:**
 - Avoid coarse, rough, or rude language.
 - Observe good grammar and spelling.
- **Use appropriate intensifiers to help convey meaning:**
 - Avoid "flaming" (online screaming) or sentences typed in all caps.
 - Use asterisks surrounding words to indicate italics used for emphasis (*at last*)
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UNIVERSITY POLICIES & STUDENT RESOURCES

Academic Integrity: The following guidelines will be strictly enforced with regard to the submission of all coursework: All work submitted for a grade in this course must be 100 percent your own work and must reflect the language structures and vocabulary that are taught in your course. Written work that reflects language skills that are more advanced than what is expected at your course level will be corroborated with your oral proficiency skills. The use of your textbook as a reference is permissible when completing homework and any in-class assignments, such as compositions. Unauthorized use of translators, such as Google Translate or any other AI tools, is prohibited and the unauthorized use of such tools is considered plagiarism in your Spanish class. It is the student's responsibility to abide by the [University of Arizona Code of Academic Integrity](#). Any work submitted for

a grade in which unauthorized help was used will receive a grade of zero (0) regardless of the source of help in question. Violations will be reported to the Dean of Students.

Accessibility and Accommodations: At the University of Arizona, we strive to make learning experiences as accessible as possible. If you anticipate or experience barriers based on disability or pregnancy, please contact the Disability Resource Center (520-621-3268, <https://drc.arizona.edu>) to establish reasonable accommodations.

DRC is designated by the institution to ensure access for disabled students and employees. As such, all disability documentation and requests for accommodations must be handled by DRC.

The UA's policies concerning Class Attendance and Participation is available at: <https://catalog.arizona.edu/policy/class-attendance-and-participation>.

The UA policy regarding absences for any sincerely held religious belief, observance or practice will be accommodated where reasonable, [http://policy.arizona.edu/human-resources/religious-accommodation-policy\(link is external\)](http://policy.arizona.edu/human-resources/religious-accommodation-policy(link%20is%20external)).

Absences and withdrawals

Registrar's Office (important dates), Spanish Advising (where students can ask questions regarding declaring a minor, adding/dropping a class, and other class information), Dean of Students Office (where students submit documentation required for instructors to be able to accept late work outside of the 1-time courtesy), Campus Health (where students submit documentation to initiate medical withdrawals), and Counseling & Psych Services (where students can seek crisis support).

- Registrar office: <https://registrar.arizona.edu/dates-and-deadlines>
- Advising: <https://spanish.arizona.edu/undergraduate/current-students/advising-faq>
- Dean of Students: <https://deanofstudents.arizona.edu/support/student-assistance>
- Campus Health: <https://www.health.arizona.edu/academic-absences-withdrawals>
- CAPS: <https://caps.arizona.edu/services>

As a University of Arizona Student, you have the support of our wildcat community. I have outlined above the commonly searched information, but you can review the detailed list of university policies and resources by clicking on this link:

<https://academicaffairs.arizona.edu/syllabus-policies>

Subject to Change Statement: Information contained in the course syllabus, other than the grade and absence policy, may be subject to change with advance notice, as deemed appropriate by the instructor.

I'm excited to get started and help you explore the exciting culture of Spanish-speaking countries through their traditions! If you have any questions or need assistance, please reach out.

